
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English

Books



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Neil

Hello and welcome back to Real Easy English, the podcast where we have real conversations in easy English to help you learn. I'm Neil.

Becca

And I'm Becca. You can find a video version with subtitles of this podcast on our website bbclearningenglish.com.

Neil

Hi Becca. How are you?

Becca

Yeah, I'm well, thank you Neil. How about yourself?

Neil

I'm very good. I'm excited because we're talking about books and reading today, and I really love reading. How about you?

Becca

Yeah, I like reading as well. I do like reading. How often do you read, though?

Neil

Well, I read every day, but different types of things. So, I do... I sit down and read for the longest period of time and the most serious kind of book when I'm travelling to and from work.

Becca

Oh! OK.

Neil

Yeah. And when I'm at home, I read stuff that's not so difficult, because usually at home I just fall asleep if I read.

Becca

Yeah. So, I see a lot of people reading on the tube and I wish I could be that kind of person, but for me, I only read when I'm in a relaxed environment. So, like, sometimes I'll go to the park in summer or take a book to the beach. So, I do like reading, but I don't read as often as I feel like I should.

Neil

So, Becca, what kind of books do you like to read?

Becca

I like short books. I sometimes feel a bit stressed when I see a long, thick book. A lot of the books that I have on my shelf at home are **poems**. Poetry is a form of literature that... It's usually quite emotional and a lot shorter than a short story or, like, a **novel**, for example. Yeah, **poems** – they also sometimes have a lovely kind of sound quality to them, if you read them loud. So, some of the words might rhyme, and they use a lot of metaphor. So, I really enjoy short stories or books that have lots of **poems** in them. How about yourself, Neil? What stories or what books do you enjoy?

Neil

I like **fiction**. So, **fiction** is when the story is not true. It's made up by the writer. And I like **novels**. And **novels** are **fiction** books. That's just one quite long story. So, you know, probably more than 100 or 150 pages. Otherwise, it's a short story. Short stories are...

Both

...shorter!

Becca

Yes. Have you ever read a **non-fiction** book? So, maybe, something that's based on, like, a real event or like a **biography** from someone's perspective that you really enjoyed?

Neil

Yeah, I like reading biographies as well. So, a **biography** is somebody's life story. I like biographies of musicians and people like that.

Becca

Yeah, I know you play guitar, so music seems to be quite a hobby that you enjoy.

Neil

Yeah.

Becca

Yeah.

Neil

Yeah, definitely. And I like reading about the lives of people who've worked in music.

Becca

Mmm.

Neil

Do you like **non-fiction**?

Becca

I prefer to watch **non-fiction**. I prefer to watch documentaries. I haven't read many **non-fiction** books.

Neil

Do you have a favourite author? Author – an author is a person who writes books.

Becca

Mmm yeah. So, actually a lot of my favourite authors – some of them have written **novels**. I prefer poets, so authors that have written **poems**. And I prefer them because they're quite moving and usually quite short as well. So, I find that the authors that I enjoy the most write short things, like **poems** or short stories.

Neil

OK. Let's recap some of the vocabulary we've heard in this podcast, starting with **fiction**. **Fiction** is a type of writing where the story is not true – it's made up. And the opposite is **non-fiction**. **Non-fiction** is a true story.

Becca

And our next word – **novel**. A **novel** is a **fiction**, and it's usually a longer story.

Neil

We also heard the word **biography**. A **biography** is a type of book about a person's life, and if that person wrote the story of their own life, it's called an **autobiography**.

Becca

We also mentioned **poems**. Now, **poems** are a shorter piece of writing, even shorter than a short story or a **novel**. And the sounds of the words and the ideas are very important in poetry.

Neil

That's it for this episode of Real Easy English, but don't forget to go to our website. That's bbclearningenglish.com, where you can find a free worksheet.

Becca

And we'll be back next week with another conversation in easy English. Goodbye for now!

Neil

Goodbye!